The Bengaluru Spoken Kannada Corpus: A Lexical and Morphosyntactic Guide for Migrant Integration

The acquisition of a new language within a rapidly expanding, multicultural urban ecosystem such as Bengaluru requires a pedagogical approach that fundamentally diverges from traditional, textbook-driven language learning. The linguistic landscape of this metropolis is defined by a highly dynamic, colloquial dialect that prioritizes functional utility, contextual pragmatics, and an intricate hierarchy of social honorifics.[1] For a migrant or expatriate attempting to navigate the logistical, commercial, and social realities of the city, rote memorization of formal, literary vocabulary is largely inefficient. Furthermore, the pervasive penetration of the English language into the daily vernacular means that native Kannada speakers are entirely comfortable utilizing English terms for modern institutions, technological devices, and emergency services. Consequently, attempting to memorize the pure Kannada equivalents for words like "ambulance," "hospital," "doctor," "bus," or "office" represents a misallocation of cognitive resources.[1]

Instead, fluency in Bengaluru is achieved by mastering the foundational morphosyntactic engines of the language—specifically its agglutinative structure—and populating that engine with high-utility, domain-specific vocabulary related to public transport, local market negotiation, and domestic administration. Kannada, as a prominent member of the South Dravidian language family, operates on a strict morphosyntactic framework that differs radically from the fusional nature of Indo-Aryan languages like Hindi or English.[1] It utilizes agglutination, a process wherein discrete, unchanging suffixes (morphemes) are sequentially attached or "glued" to an unmodified root word to convey complex grammatical relationships such as tense, case, number, and person.[1]

The following research report and its accompanying curated corpus synthesize the essential grammatical mechanisms and lexical items required for daily living in Bengaluru. The data is stratified into three progressive tiers of cognitive and logistical complexity, formatted specifically for implementation into spaced-repetition flashcard systems. This structured approach guarantees that learners bypass redundant vocabulary and focus intensely on the syntactic patterns and colloquialisms that signal cultural integration and linguistic competence.

Tier 1: Foundational Survival and Logistical Navigation

The primary objective for any newcomer to Bengaluru is to establish spatial awareness, execute basic financial transactions, and initiate polite, transactional communication with service personnel, auto-rickshaw drivers, and local vendors.[1] Achieving this requires the

immediate internalization of three distinct linguistic components: the hierarchy of pronouns, the base-10 numerical system, and the core imperative verbs governing movement and exchange.

Spoken Bengaluru Kannada enforces a strict sociolinguistic hierarchy, categorized by grammarians into the *Mahat* (Rational) and *Amahat* (Irrational) paradigms.[1] Human beings fall into the *Mahat* category and are addressed according to their social standing and age relative to the speaker. The most critical distinction for a beginner is navigating the second-person pronouns. *Neevu* serves as the respectful, formal "You" (equivalent to the Hindi "Aap" or French "Vous"), and is the absolute default for addressing strangers, shopkeepers, auto drivers, and colleagues.[1] Conversely, *Neenu* is the informal, casual "You" (equivalent to "Tu"), strictly reserved for young children, younger siblings, or extremely close intimates. Utilizing *Neenu* with a service worker or a stranger is perceived as deeply offensive and immediately marks the speaker as culturally ignorant.[1]

This dichotomy extends directly to verb conjugation, specifically the imperative mood used for giving commands or making requests.[1] Kannada verb roots generally end in a euphonic vowel (*-u* or *-i*).[6] When issuing a command to an individual addressed as *Neevu*, the speaker must append a respectful suffix, typically converting the terminal vowel to *-i* or appending *-ri*. For example, the root verb *Mādu* (to do) becomes the polite imperative *Mādi* (please do).[1] The root *Kodu* (to give) becomes *Kodi* (please give).[4] This simple morphological adjustment transforms a harsh demand into a culturally appropriate request, smoothing daily logistical interactions.[2]

Furthermore, the formulation of interrogatives in Kannada diverges from Indo-Aryan patterns. While Kannada possesses specific question words (such as *Yenu* for What, *Elli* for Where, and *Yaaru* for Who), it also employs a highly efficient interrogative suffix.[1] Any standard declarative statement can be instantly transformed into a binary Yes/No question simply by elongating the terminal vowel of the focal word, adding the *-aa* suffix. For instance, the statement "Idu pustaka" (This is a book) becomes the question "Idu pustakavaa?" (Is this a book?).[1] Recognizing this acoustic marker is essential for basic comprehension during rapid street-level exchanges.

The following table isolates fifty high-frequency, absolute-survival lexical items, optimized for immediate deployment in public transport and preliminary social encounters.

Deck 1: Foundation, Spatial Logistics, and Respect Equivalents

English	Kannada (transliterated)	Notes

I / Me	Naanu	The first-person singular pronoun. Used primarily in the nominative case. Acts as the anchor for self-identification.[1] *Example: Naanu hogthini (I will go).* [10]
You (Respectful)	Neevu	The polite second-person pronoun. The absolute default for strangers, vendors, and colleagues in Bengaluru.[1] *Example: Neevu hegiddiri? (How are you?)* [8]
You (Informal)	Neenu	Reserved strictly for close friends or children. Avoid using with service personnel.[1] *Example: Neenu hegiddiya? (How are you?)* [8]
He / She / They (Respect)	Avaru	The third-person respectful pronoun. Functions for both genders when respect is required, and serves as the general plural "they".[1] *Example: Avaru bandaru (They came).* [48]
We	Naavu	The first-person plural pronoun. Used inclusively.[1] *Example: Naavu hogona (Let's go).*
This (Thing/Animal)	Idu	Demonstrative pronoun. Refers to an inanimate object or animal in close physical proximity (Amahat category).[1] *Example: Idu chennagide (This is good).*

		[2]
That (Thing/Animal)	Adu	Demonstrative pronoun. Refers to an object or animal at a distance.[1] *Example: Adu nanage beku (I want that).* [48]
Here	Illi	Spatial marker. Essential for instructing transport drivers where to stop.[1] *Example: Illi nillisi (Stop here).* [2]
There	Alli	Spatial marker denoting a distant location.[1] *Example: Alli hogi (Go there).* [10]
Where?	Elli?	The primary spatial interrogative. Often combined with directional suffixes.[1] *Example: Metro station elli? (Where is the metro station?)* [2]
What?	Yenu? / Enu?	The universal interrogative for objects and concepts. Can also express surprise or a request for repetition.[4] *Example: Nimma hesaru yenu? (What is your name?)* [2]
How much?	Yeshtu? / Eshtu?	Critical for all financial transactions, auto-rickshaw negotiations, and market inquiries.[2] *Example: Idara bele eshtu? (What is the price of this?)* [2]

Who?	Yaaru?	The interrogative for identifying people.[4] *Example: Avaru yaaru? (Who is that?)* [10]
Why?	Yaake?	Interrogative used to demand reasoning or causation.[4] *Example: Idu yaake? (Why is this?)* [10]
Yes	Haudu	Affirmative response. The 'ou' diphthong is pronounced similarly to the 'o' in "go".[4] *Example: Haudu, adu nanage beku (Yes, I need it).* [48]
No / Does not exist	Illa	Negative response indicating absence or disagreement. Pronounced with emphasis on the first syllable.[4] *Example: Nanna hathira change illa (I don't have change).* [7]
Want / Need	Beku	An essential modal verb indicating desire or requirement. Used pervasively in commercial transactions.[2] *Example: Nanage oota beku (I want food).*
Do not want / Do not need	Beda	The negative counterpart to *Beku*. Useful for declining offers, refusing higher fares, or dismissing hawkers.[2] *Example: Nanage idu beda (I don't want this).* [7]

Come	Banni (Respectful)	Imperative verb. The root is *Baa*, but *Banni* is the required formal application for daily use.[1] *Example: Olagade banni (Come inside).*
Go	Hogi (Respectful)	Imperative verb. Essential for directing transport. Root is *Hogu*.[1] *Example: Nera hogi (Go straight).* [8]
Give	Kodi (Respectful)	Imperative verb. Used when requesting items in a shop or asking for a ticket. Root is *Kodu*.[1] *Example: Ondu ticket kodi (Give me one ticket).* [7]
Take	Thagonli (Respectful)	Imperative verb. Used when handing cash or items to a vendor. Root is *Thogo*.[1] *Example: Kode togolli (Take the umbrella).* [10]
Do / Make	Maadi (Respectful)	The universal auxiliary verb. Often appended to English nouns to create 'Kanglish' verbs (e.g., "Adjust maadi").[1] *Example: Bill maadi (Make the bill).* [2]
Stop	Nillisi (Respectful)	Imperative verb. The standard command for instructing an auto or cab driver to halt.[1] *Example: Bus nillisi (Stop the bus).* [10]
Look / See	Nodi (Respectful)	Imperative verb. Used to direct someone's attention or request they inspect something.[1] *Example: Nodi*

		alli (Look there). [10]
Tell / Say	Heli (Respectful)	Imperative verb. Used to prompt information, such as asking a vendor to state a final price.[1] *Example: Matte heli (Please say that again).* [8]
Listen / Ask	Keli (Respectful)	Imperative verb. Used to gain attention before a question.[1] *Example: Daya vittu keli (Please listen).* [10]
Straight	Nera	Directional adverb. Used extensively in navigation ("Nera hogi" - Go straight).[1] *Example: Nera hogi (Go straight).* [8]
Left	Edagade / Eda	Directional noun. *Eda* means left, *gade* means side. Vital for guiding transport.[1] *Example: Edakke tirigi (Turn left).* [8]
Right	Balagade / Bala	Directional noun. *Bala* means right, *gade* means side.[1] *Example: Balakke tirigi (Turn right).* [8]
Forward / Ahead	Mundhe	Spatial marker. Often combined with the imperative stop ("Mundhe nillisi" - Stop ahead).[1] *Example: Mundhe hogi (Go ahead).*
Backward / Behind	Hindhe	Spatial marker. Indicates the rear or reversing direction.[1] *Example: Hindhe banni (Come backwards).*

Inside	Olagade	Spatial marker. Useful for directing delivery personnel to leave items inside a gate or door.[12] *Example: Olagade banni (Come inside).* [12]
Outside	Horagade / Aache	Spatial marker. Used to instruct drivers, delivery agents, or guests to wait externally.[12] *Example: Aache iri (Stay outside).* [12]
A little / Slightly	Swalpa	A highly utilized adverb. Can mean a small amount of an item, or function as a polite conversational softener.[3] *Example: Swalpa kammi maadi (Reduce it a little).* [3]
Too much / More	Jaasthi	Adverb indicating excess. Frequently used in market bargaining ("Thumba jaasthi" - Too expensive).[3] *Example: Thumba jaasthi (Too expensive).* [3]
Fast / Quickly	Bega	Adverb of speed. Used to urge drivers or request expedited service ("Bega hogi" - Go fast).[3] *Example: Bega hogi (Go fast).* [3]
Slow / Slowly	Nidhana / Mellage	Adverb of speed. Essential for requesting individuals to speak slower ("Salpa nidhanaagi maatadi") or drive carefully.[2] *Example: Salpa nidhanaagi maatadi (Speak slowly).* [2]

Good / Well	Chennagide	Adjective/State indicating satisfactory quality. Applied to food, weather, or general states of being.[1] *Example: Oota chennagide (Food is good).* [2]
Bad	Ketta	Adjective describing poor quality or negative states.[1] *Example: Idu ketta (This is bad).*
Correct / Okay	Sari	Agreement particle. Used to confirm instructions, agree to a price, or acknowledge a statement.[3] *Example: Sari, hogona (Okay, let's go).* [10]
One	Ondu	The foundational numeric unit. Also functions syntactically as an indefinite article (a/an).[1] *Example: Ondu ticket kodi (Give one ticket).* [7]
Two	Eradu	Numeric unit. Central to basic counting and market transactions.[1] *Example: Eradu coffee kodi (Give two coffees).* [10]
Three	Mooru	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Mooru beku (I want three).*
Four	Naalku	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Naalku ticket kodi (Give four tickets).*
Five	Aidhu	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Aidu nimisha (Five minutes).*

Six	Aaru	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Aaru roopayi (Six rupees).*
Seven	Yelu	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Yelu gante (Seven o'clock).*
Eight	Entu	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Entu dina (Eight days).*
Nine	Ombathu	Numeric unit.[1] *Example: Ombathu sathi (Nine times).*
Ten	Hattu	Numeric unit. Demonstrates the historical Proto-Dravidian 'p' to 'h' shift (from the ancient root *Pattu*).[1] *Example: Hattu roopayi kodi (Give ten rupees).*

Tier 2: Intermediate Morphosyntax, Agglutination, and Temporal Mechanics

Advancing beyond basic survival interactions demands an understanding of Kannada's internal structural logic, specifically its system of case declensions, temporal verb infixes, and compound number generation. The intermediate tier focuses heavily on replacing English prepositions with Kannada postpositional suffixes, enabling the learner to construct full, grammatically sound sentences rather than relying on fragmented vocabulary.[1]

In fusional Indo-Aryan languages like Hindi, spatial and syntactic relationships are managed via separate postpositions that follow a noun (e.g., *ghar mein* - in the house, *ghar ko* - to the house). Kannada, conversely, utilizes a system of eight *Vibhaktis* (Case Declensions). These are discrete suffixes glued directly onto the noun base.[1] Mastering these suffixes accelerates comprehension exponentially, as they map predictably to English and Hindi equivalents. The Sapthami Vibhakti (Locative case) utilizes the suffix *-alli* to denote location in space or time, translating to "in" or "on" (e.g., *Mane* + *y* + *alli* = *Maneyalli* / In the house).[1] The Chaturthi Vibhakti (Dative case) employs *-ge*, *-ige*, or *-kke* to indicate the target or recipient, translating to "to" (e.g., *Office-ge* / To the office).[1] The Triteeya Vibhakti (Instrumental case) uses *-inda* to indicate means or origin, translating to "from" or "by" (e.g., *Bengaluru-ninda* / From Bengaluru).[1]

When these suffixes are chained to a root word, Kannada frequently employs euphonic mutation rules known as *Sandhi* to resolve vowel clashes and ensure phonetic fluidity. *Agama Sandhi* involves the insertion of a glide consonant (typically *-y-* or *-v-*) between a root ending in a vowel and a suffix beginning with a vowel, preventing an awkward hiatus.[1] Recognizing these glides is crucial for decoding spoken Kannada, as words visually expand when spoken (e.g., *Mane* + *alli* becomes *Maneyalli*, not *Manealli*).[1]

Equally critical at this stage is the mastery of the "Experiencer Dative" paradigm.[1] A fundamental syntactic shift is required for English speakers: sentences expressing biological needs, emotional states, physical sensations, or possession do not utilize the nominative "I" (*Naanu*). Instead, Dravidian linguistics posits that the experience "happens to" the subject, necessitating the dative form "To Me" (*Nanage*). Therefore, one does not say "I am hungry" or "I know"; one states "To me, hunger has happened" (*Nanage hasivu agide*) and "To me, it is known" (*Nanage gothu*).[1]

The temporal engine of Kannada verbs is similarly logical. Tense is indicated by a specific infix placed strictly between the verb root and the terminal personal pronoun suffix. The present/habitual tense utilizes the infix *-utt-* or *-t-*, the past tense uses *-id-*, *-d-*, or *-t-*, and the future tense employs *-uv-* or *-v-*.[1] For example, the root *Hogu* (Go) combined with the present infix *-t-* and the first-person singular suffix *-ini* creates *Hogthini* (I go / I am going), a crucial verb form for indicating current action.[1]

Finally, the intermediate numerical system expands into the tens. The numbers 11 through 19 are formed by fusing the base ten (*Hattu*) with the singular digits, undergoing sandhi to create the prefix *Hadi-* (e.g., *Hadimooru* for 13).[15] The multiples of ten possess a terminal *-ttu* suffix, acting similarly to the English "-ty" (e.g., *Ippattu* for 20, *Moovattu* for 30).[15]

Deck 2: Agglutinative Logic, Temporal Markers, and States of Being

English	Kannada (transliterated)	Notes
Eleven	Hannondu	Numeric compound. Demonstrates Sandhi: fusion of *Hattu* (10) and *Ondu* (1).[15] *Example: Hannondu roopayi.*
Twelve	Hanneradu	Numeric compound. 10 + 2.[15] *Example: Hanneradu nimisha.*

Thirteen	Hadimooru	Numeric compound. The prefix *Hadi-* signifies the 'teen' equivalent in Kannada grammar.[15] *Example: Hadimooru dina.*
Fourteen	Hadinaalku	Numeric compound. 10 + 4.[15] *Example: Hadinaalku jana.*
Fifteen	Hadinaidu	Numeric compound. 10 + 5.[15] *Example: Hadinaidu nimisha.*
Sixteen	Hadinaaru	Numeric compound. 10 + 6.[15] *Example: Hadinaaru roopayi.*
Seventeen	Hadinelu	Numeric compound. 10 + 7.[15] *Example: Hadinelu gante.*
Eighteen	Hadinentu	Numeric compound. 10 + 8.[15] *Example: Hadinentu varsha.*
Nineteen	Hattombattu	Numeric compound. 10 + 9.[15] *Example: Hattombattu roopayi.*
Twenty	Ippattu	The base unit for the twenties. The '-ttu' ending denotes multiples of ten.[15] *Example: Ippattu roopayi kodi (Give twenty rupees).*
Thirty	Moovattu	Numeric multiple of ten. Used constantly in small retail and transport.[15] *Example: Moovattu nimisha (Thirty minutes).*

Forty	Nalavattu	Numeric multiple of ten.[15] *Example: Nalavattu roopayi.*
Fifty	Aivattu	Numeric multiple of ten.[15] *Example: Aivattu roopayi.*
One Hundred	Nooru	The base unit for hundreds. Vital for larger transactions and rent discussions.[2] *Example: Ondu nooru roopayi (One hundred rupees).*
One Thousand	Saavira	The base unit for thousands.[11] *Example: Ondu saavira roopayi.*
In / On (Locative)	-alli / -nalli	The Sapthami Vibhakti suffix. Indicates location in space or time. Replaces prepositions like 'in' or 'at'.[1] *Example: Maneyalli idini (I am in the house).*
To (Dative)	-ge / -ige / -kke	The Chaturthi Vibhakti suffix. Indicates the target destination or recipient. Crucial for transport routing.[1] *Example: Office-ge hogthini (Going to the office).*
From / By (Instrumental)	-inda / -ninda	The Triteeya Vibhakti suffix. Indicates origin or means. Frequently serves as an ablative in colloquial speech.[1] *Example: Bengaluru-ninda bande (I came from Bengaluru).* [8]
Of (Genitive)	-a / -ina / -na	The Shashti Vibhakti suffix. Indicates possession or

		relationship, replacing the English 'Of'.[1] *Example: Avara mane (Their house).* [7]
Plural Suffix (Inanimate)	-galu	The primary agglutinative suffix to indicate plurality for non-human objects.[18] *Example: Pustakagalu (Books).* [49]
Plural Suffix (Human)	-ru / -aru	The specific plural suffix reserved for the Mahat (Rational) category, denoting respect or multiple people.[1] *Example: Avaru bandaru (They came).* [48]
To me	Nanage / Nange	The dative form of the first-person pronoun. The absolute anchor for all experiential verbs.[1] *Example: Nanage beku (I want).*
To you	Nimage (Respectful)	The dative form of the respectful second-person pronoun.[1] *Example: Nimage yenu beku? (What do you want?)*
Now	Eega	Temporal adverb indicating the present moment. Used to demand immediate action.[1] *Example: Eega banni (Come now).*
Later / Afterwards	Aamele	Temporal adverb. Extremely common in delaying tactics or scheduling.[1] *Example: Aamele maadi (Do it later).*

Today	Ivathu / Ivattu	Temporal noun indicating the current day.[1] *Example: Ivathu male ide (It is raining today).*
Tomorrow	Naale	Temporal noun indicating the future day. Often used to postpone vendor visits or meetings.[1] *Example: Naale barthini (I will come tomorrow).* [10]
Yesterday	Ninne	Temporal noun indicating the previous day.[1] *Example: Ninne bande (I came yesterday).* [8]
Morning	Beligge	Temporal noun indicating the period before noon.[1] *Example: Shubha beligge (Good morning).* [8]
Afternoon	Madhyahna	Temporal noun indicating midday.[2] *Example: Shubha madhyahna (Good afternoon).* [2]
Evening	Sanje / Saayankala	Temporal noun indicating the period before sunset.[1] *Example: Sanje sigona (Let's meet in the evening).*
Night	Rathri	Temporal noun indicating nighttime.[1] *Example: Shubha rathri (Good night).* [10]
Time	Samaya / Hothu	Noun. Used to ask duration or exact clock time.[1] *Example: Samaya eshtu? (What is the time?)* [7]

And	Mattu	Conjunction. Used to link similar items in lists or connect parallel ideas.[21] *Example: Naanu mattu neenu (Me and you).*
But	Aadare / Adare	Conjunction. Essential for building complex sentences and introducing contrast.[21] *Example: Baruttini, aadare late agutte (I will come, but it will be late).* [21]
Or	Athava	Conjunction. Used for presenting options or choices in a transaction.[22] *Example: Idu athava adu (This or that).*
Because	Ekeandre	Conjunction. Combines *Yake* (why) and *Andare* (if said). Used to provide reasoning.[21] *Example: Late aayithu ekeandre traffic ittu (Late because there was traffic).* [21]
Therefore / So	Aadirinda	Conjunction. Used to indicate causality and result.[22] *Example: Aadirinda naanu hogilla (Therefore I didn't go).*
Known	Gothu	Experiential verb indicating knowledge. Syntax requires the dative subject.[1] *Example: Nanage gothu (To me it is known).*
Unknown / I don't know	Gothilla	The negative experiential verb. Highly useful for establishing boundaries

		regarding local knowledge.[1] *Example: Kannada gothilla (I don't know Kannada).* [9]
Hunger	Hasivu	Noun. Expressed experientially.[1] *Example: Nanage hasivu agtide (I am feeling hungry).*
Thirst	Bayarike	Noun. Expressed experientially: *Nanage bayarike agide* (To me thirst has happened).[14] *Example: Nanage bayarike agide.*
Pain	Novu	Noun. Used with the dative subject to express physical distress.[3] *Example: Thumba novu ide (There is severe pain).* [3]
Anger	Kopa	Noun. Expressed dynamically.[1] *Example: Nanage kopa bandide (I am angry).*
Fear	Bhaya	Noun. Expressed experientially.[1] *Example: Nanage bhaya agide (I am afraid).*
Is / Exists	Ide	Third-person neuter verb of existence. Used to confirm availability.[2] *Example: Neeru ideya? (Is there water?)* [3]
Is not / Does not exist	Illa	Functions both as the standalone "No" and the verb of non-existence, denying availability.[2]

		Example: Alli yaaru illa (No one is there). [2]
I go / am going	Hogthini / Hoguttene	Present/Future continuous finite verb. Formed by Root (*Hogu*) + Tense (*-t-*) + Pronoun (*-ini/-ene*).[1] *Example: Naanu office-ge hogthini (I am going to the office).* [10]
I come / am coming	Barthini / Baruttene	Present/Future continuous finite verb. Indicates intention to arrive. Highly useful for delivery updates.[1] *Example: Naale barthini (I will come tomorrow).* [10]
Finished / Done	Aayithu / Aytha	Past tense completion marker.[1] *Example: Kelsa aayitha? (Is the work done?)* [10]
Only / Itself (Emphasis)	-ee / -ne	An exclusive emphatic suffix attached directly to a noun. Replaces the English "only" (*Naane* = Only me).[1] *Example: Naane barthini (I myself will come).*
Also / Even (Emphasis)	-uu / -nu	An inclusive emphatic suffix. Replaces the English "also" (*Naanuu* = Me too).[1] *Example: Naanuu barthini (I will also come).*
Big / Large	Dodda	Adjective. Precedes the noun in syntactic order, matching English adjective placement.[7] *Example: Dodda mane (Big house).* [26]

Small	Chikka / Sanna	Adjective. Precedes the noun.[2] *Example: Chikka kurchi (Small chair).*
Hot (Temperature)	Bisi	Adjective. Used for climate, objects, and food.[25] *Example: Bisi anna (Hot rice).* [26]
Cold (Temperature)	Thannige / Sheeta	Adjective. Used for liquids or weather.[1] *Example: Thannige neeru kodi (Give cold water).*
New	Hosa	Adjective.[7] *Example: Hosa mane (New house).*
Old	Hale	Adjective. Demonstrates the p -> h shift from Proto-Dravidian *Pazhaya*.[1] *Example: Hale mane (Old house).*

Tier 3: Advanced Domestic Logistics, Cultural Fluency, and Slang

True integration into the sociolinguistic fabric of Bengaluru requires expanding the lexicon beyond transactional logistics and into highly specific domestic, commercial, and emotional spheres. The advanced tier facilitates complex interactions involving house maintenance, culinary administration, local market navigation, and nuanced emotional expression.

A defining characteristic of this tier is the specialized syntax of the kitchen and domestic management.[9] While professionals in corporate Bengaluru utilize English exclusively, local vendors in wet markets (KR Market, Russell Market) and domestic service workers prioritize native Kannada terminology.[23] For instance, requesting an "onion" may cause minor friction, whereas utilizing the native *Eerulli* instantly bridges the communication gap.[23] This tier explicitly catalogues the native taxonomy for vegetables, groceries, and household items, filtering out words where the English loanword is already ubiquitous.

Furthermore, this level introduces the advanced grammatical frameworks necessary for expressing conditional logic and complex relationships. In Kannada, relative clauses (e.g., "The man who saw me") do not use independent relative pronouns like "who" or "which."

Instead, they rely on Relative Participles.[31] By taking the past or future stem of a verb and adding the suffix *-a*, the verb becomes an adjectival participle (e.g., *Nōḍu* [to see] -> *Nōḍid* [saw] -> *Nōḍida* [the one who saw / which was seen]). The participle precedes the noun it modifies, condensing complex thoughts into highly efficient structures.[31] Similarly, First Conditional statements ("If X, then Y") are generated either by utilizing the conditional suffix *-are* attached to a verb, or by structuring the sentence with the temporal marker *Eega* (If/Now) at the head of the conditional clause.[33]

The lexicon is further enriched by recognizing the historical evolution of the language. Due to centuries of religious and literary contact, Kannada vocabulary relies heavily on Sanskrit borrowings, categorized into *Tatsama* (exact phonetic adoptions like *Mukha* for face) and *Tadbhava* (words modified to fit Kannada phonology, like *Moga*).[1] Additionally, the defining phonological evolution separating Modern Kannada from its sister South Dravidian languages (like Tamil) is the systematic lenition of the initial bilabial plosive /p/ to the glottal fricative /h/.[1] Recognizing this rule unlocks hundreds of core vocabulary words for anyone with exposure to other Dravidian tongues (e.g., *Paal* becomes *Haalu* [Milk], *Pattu* becomes *Hattu*).[1]

Finally, no integration into Bengaluru is complete without a working knowledge of its dynamic street slang and idiomatic expressions. The local dialect effortlessly incorporates loanwords from neighboring Tamil and Telugu, generating a rich tapestry of conversational softeners, playful insults, and expressions of camaraderie.[1] Mastering terms like *Maga* (Dude/Son), *Bombaat* (Fantastic), and the cultural cornerstone *Swalpa adjust maadi* (Please compromise/make space) signals a profound respect for the regional identity and immediately transitions the speaker from an outsider to an integrated resident.[1]

Deck 3: Domestic Administration, Advanced Grammar, and Street Lexicon

English	Kannada (transliterated)	Notes
House / Home	Mane	Noun. Foundational word for renting and directing delivery logistics. Derives the locative *Maneyalli* (in the house).[1] *Example: Mane beku (I need a house).* [3]
Rent	Baadige	Noun. Essential for residential negotiation and lease discussions with

		landlords.[36] *Example: Rent eshtu? (How much is the rent?)* [3]
Room	Kone	Noun. Used in real estate discussions and domestic management.[37] *Example: Ondu kone beku (I need a room).*
Water	Neeru	Noun. Vital for discussing utility availability during house hunting and dining.[2] *Example: Neeru kodi (Give water).* [10]
Electricity / Power	Current / Vidyut	Noun. While *Vidyut* is the formal term, *Current* is universally adapted into the Kannada framework for utility discussions.[3] *Example: Current ideya? (Is electricity available?)* [3]
Kitchen	Aduge mane	Compound noun. Literally translates to "cooking house".[37] *Example: Aduge mane ellide? (Where is the kitchen?)*
Sweep the floor	Kasam gudisu	Verb phrase used for domestic help. *Kasam* refers to dust/trash, and *gudisu* is the specific action of sweeping.[23] *Example: Aa moolay sariyage gudisu (Sweep that corner properly).*
Wipe the floor	Nela oresu	Verb phrase. *Nela* signifies the floor/ground, and *oresu* is the action of wiping or

		mopping.[23] *Example: Manay nelavannu saarsu (Mop the floor of the house).*
Wash the vessels	Paathre tolee	Verb phrase. *Paathre* refers to culinary vessels/pots, and *tolee* means to wash hard objects.[23] *Example: Musaray patre modalu tholi (Do the dishes first).*
Wash the clothes	Batte ogey	Verb phrase. *Batte* means fabric/clothing. *Ogey* is a highly specific verb used strictly for the action of laundering textiles.[23] *Example: Battey sariyage vagaya beku (Wash the clothes properly).*
Throw the trash	Kasa haaki	Verb phrase. Instructs the disposal of waste. *Haaki* (from *haaku*) means to put or drop.[1] *Example: Kasa haaki (Throw the trash).*
Vegetables	Tharakari / Tarakaarigalu	Noun. Pluralized with *-galu*. Essential category for local market shopping.[23] *Example: Tharakari beku (I need vegetables).* [45]
Onion	Eerulli / Ullagadde	Noun. A staple ingredient; native market sellers rarely use the English term.[23] *Example: Eerulli eshtu? (How much for onions?)* [38]
Garlic	Bellulli	Noun. Compound word. *Belli* (white/silver) + *Ulli* (bulb/onion).[23] *Example:*

		Bellulli beku (I need garlic).
Ginger	Shunti	Noun. Essential culinary term.[23] *Example: Shunti kodi (Give ginger).*
Chilli / Pepper	Menasinakai / Menasu	Noun. *Menasu* refers to pepper, while the suffix *-kai* denotes the raw vegetable pod.[23] *Example: Menasinakai swalpa kodi (Give a little chilli).*
Coriander Leaves	Kothambari soppu	Noun. *Soppu* denotes any leafy green. Used when requesting fresh herbs in the market.[23] *Example: Kothambari soppu beku (I want coriander leaves).*
Curry Leaves	Karibevu	Noun. Foundational ingredient in South Indian tempering.[30] *Example: Karibevu haaki (Add curry leaves).*
Spinach / Greens	Palak soppu / Soppu	Noun. General term for leafy greens.[30] *Example: Soppu eshtu? (How much are the greens?)*
Potato	Aalu-gedde	Noun. *Gedde* denotes a tuber or root vegetable.[23] *Example: Aalu-gedde beku (I want potatoes).*
Tomato	Tamatekayi / Tomato	Noun. Often localized as *Tamatekayi* in rural markets.[30] *Example: Tomato eshtu? (How much are tomatoes?)*

Carrot	Gajjari / Gajara	Noun. Used frequently in vegetable markets.[30] *Example: Gajjari beku (I need carrots).*
Cabbage	Ele kosu	Compound noun. *Ele* (leaf) + *Kosu* (cabbage family).[30] *Example: Ele kosu kodi (Give cabbage).*
Cauliflower	Hoo kosu	Compound noun. *Hoo* (flower) + *Kosu*.[30] *Example: Hoo kosu beku (I want cauliflower).*
Brinjal / Eggplant	Badanekayi	Noun. A very common local vegetable, essential to know.[30] *Example: Badanekayi eshtu? (How much for brinjal?)*
Lady's Finger / Okra	Bendekayi	Noun. Used in common local curries.[30] *Example: Bendekayi kodi (Give okra).*
Cucumber	Southekayi	Noun. Common salad ingredient.[30] *Example: Southekayi beku (I need cucumber).*
Bottle Gourd	Sorekayi	Noun. Common native gourd.[30] *Example: Sorekayi beku (I want bottle gourd).*
Bitter Gourd	Hagalakayi	Noun. Recognized for its distinct flavor profile.[30] *Example: Hagalakayi beda (I don't want bitter gourd).*
Ridge Gourd	Heerekayi	Noun. Widely used in native gravies and chutneys.[30] *Example: Heerekayi beku (I*

		need ridge gourd).
Beans	Huralikayi	Noun. Native term for green beans.[30] *Example: Huralikayi eshtu? (How much for beans?)*
Peas	Batani	Noun. Common vegetable.[30] *Example: Batani beku (I want peas).*
Lemon	Nimbehannu	Noun. Essential culinary term.[23] *Example: Nimbehannu kodi (Give a lemon).*
Fruit	Hannu	Noun. Refers to ripe fruits. Used as a suffix for many specific fruit names.[23] *Example: Hannu beku (I want fruit).*
Banana	Baalehannu	Compound noun. *Baale* (plantain) + *Hannu* (fruit).[30] *Example: Baalehannu kodi (Give a banana).*
Mango	Maavinahannu / Maavu	Noun. Essential seasonal fruit.[30] *Example: Maavinahannu eshtu? (How much are mangoes?)*
Apple	Sebu	Noun. Widely used in local fruit stalls.[30] *Example: Sebu beku (I want apples).*
Grapes	Draakshi	Noun. Common fruit.[30] *Example: Draakshi eshtu? (How much for grapes?)*
Orange	Kittale	Noun. Common fruit.[30] *Example: Kittale kodi (Give*

		an orange).
Raw Rice	Akki	Noun. Specifically refers to uncooked rice grains, a staple grocery purchase.[23] *Example: Akki beku (I need raw rice).*
Cooked Rice	Anna	Noun. Distinct from *Akki*; refers strictly to rice that has been boiled and prepared for consumption.[23] *Example: Anna kodi (Give cooked rice).*
Wheat	Godhi	Noun. Staple grain.[29] *Example: Godhi hittu beku (Need wheat flour).*
Milk	Haalu	Noun. Illustrates the p -> h shift from Proto-Dravidian *Paal*.[1] *Example: Haalu kodi (Give milk).*
Curd / Yogurt	Mosaru	Noun. A critical component of the South Indian diet and culinary vocabulary.[2] *Example: Mosaru beku (I want curd).*
Butter	Benne	Noun. Essential dairy product, famous in *Benne Dose*.[2] *Example: Benne dosa kodi (Give butter dosa).* [2]
Salt	Uppu	Noun. Core culinary term.[23] *Example: Uppu swalpa haaki (Put a little salt).*
Sugar	Sakkare	Noun. Core culinary term.[23]

		Example: Nannige sakkare beku (I want sugar). [29]
Oil	Enne	Noun. Refers to any cooking or application oil.[23] *Example: Enne beku (I need oil).*
Egg	Motte	Noun. Common grocery item.[38] *Example: Eradu motte kodi (Give two eggs).*
Spices	Masale	Noun. General term for spice blends.[2] *Example: Masale dosa beku (I want a masala dosa).*
Meat (General)	Mamsa	Noun. Used in non-vegetarian contexts.[41] *Example: Mamsa beku (I want meat).*
Chicken	Koli mari / Koli	Noun. Used frequently in local eateries.[10] *Example: Koli mari beku (I want chicken).* [10]
Plate	Tatte	Noun. Household and dining term.[43] *Example: Ondu tatte kodi (Give one plate).*
Cup / Glass	Lota	Noun. Used to request clean glasses in small eateries.[7] *Example: Lota tholdilva? (Haven't you washed the glass?)* [7]
Spoon	Chamacha	Noun. Dining implement.[43] *Example: Chamacha kodi (Give a spoon).*

Knife	Chaaku	Noun. Kitchen implement.[43] *Example: Chaaku beku (Need a knife).*
Chair	Kurchi	Noun. Household furniture.[43] *Example: Kurchi mele kuthkolli (Sit on the chair).*
Table	Meju	Noun. Household furniture.[43] *Example: Meju oresu (Wipe the table).*
Bed / Mattress	Haasige / Mettassu	Noun. Household furnishing.[43] *Example: Haasige madi (Make the bed).*
Blanket	Kambali	Noun. Household furnishing.[43] *Example: Kambali beku (I want a blanket).*
Towel	Tuvaalu	Noun. Bathroom necessity.[43] *Example: Tuvaalu ellide? (Where is the towel?)*
Soap	Saaboonu	Noun. Bathroom necessity.[43] *Example: Saaboonu kodi (Give soap).*
Broom	Porake / Purake	Noun. Essential for domestic cleaning instructions.[44] *Example: Porake illi ide (The broom is here).*
Bucket	Baadali / Baket	Noun. Bathroom item; *Baket* is widely accepted Kanglish.[43] *Example: Baket nalli neeru ide (There is*

		water in the bucket).
Mirror	Kannadi	Noun. Household item.[43] *Example: Kannadi nodi (Look in the mirror).*
Clock / Watch	Gadiyaara	Noun. Used to refer to timepieces.[43] *Example: Gadiyaara ellide? (Where is the clock?)*
Head	Tale	Noun. Anatomical term. Crucial for describing physical ailments.[23] *Example: Tale novu ide (I have a headache).* [26]
Hand	Kai	Noun. Anatomical term.[23] *Example: Kai toli (Wash hands).*
Leg	Kaalu	Noun. Anatomical term.[23] *Example: Kaalu novu ide (Leg is aching).*
Stomach	Hotte	Noun. Anatomical term.[23] *Example: Hotte hasivu (Stomach is hungry).*
Blood	Raktha	Noun. Essential emergency term.[23] *Example: Raktha bartide (Bleeding is happening).*
Fever	Jvara	Noun. A Tatsama (Sanskrit loanword). Expressed dynamically.[23] *Example: Jvara bandide (Got a fever).*
Cold (Illness)	Negadi	Noun. Expressed dynamically.[23] *Example:*

		Negadi agide (Caught a cold).
Pain	Novu	Noun. Used with the dative subject to express physical distress.[23] *Example: Thumba novu ide (There is severe pain).* [3]
Happiness / Joy	Santosha / Kushi	Noun. Emotional state. Expressed experientially.[14] *Example: Nanage santoshavaagide (I am happy).*
Sadness	Duhkha	Noun. Deep emotional state.[14] *Example: Nanage duhkha agide (I am sad).*
Boredom / Mild Sadness	Bejara	Noun. A highly colloquial term covering a spectrum from mild boredom to genuine sorrow.[14] *Example: Bejara aagtide (Feeling bored).*
Surprise	Aascharya	Noun. Emotional state.[14] *Example: Aascharya aayithu (I was surprised).*
Fear	Bhaya	Noun. Expressed experientially.[1] *Example: Nanage bhaya agide (I am afraid).*
Anger	Kopa	Noun. Expressed dynamically.[1] *Example: Nanage kopa bandide (I am angry).*
Friendship / Affection	Sneha	Noun. A foundational cultural concept.[14]

		Example: Nimma sneha ishta (I like your friendship).
Tasty / Delicious	Ruchi / Ruchi-agide	Adjective/State. Used to compliment culinary preparations.[8] *Example: Oota ruchi-agide (Food is tasty).* [8]
Sweet (Taste)	Sihi	Adjective describing flavor.[39] *Example: Sihi beku (Need sweets).*
Spicy / Hot	Khara	Adjective describing flavor. Central to Bengaluru culinary terminology.[2] *Example: Khara jaasthi aayithu (It became too spicy).*
Sour	Huli	Adjective describing flavor. Also refers to native tamarind-based gravies.[29] *Example: Idu huli ide (This is sour).*
Heavy / Difficult	Kashta	Adjective. Used to describe difficult tasks or heavy physical burdens.[46] *Example: Kelasa kashta ide (Work is difficult).* [3]
Explain	Vivarisu	Advanced verb. Useful in professional or detailed instructional settings.[46] *Example: Daya vittu vivarisi (Please explain).*
Allow / Permit	Anumatisu	Advanced verb. Formal term for granting permission.[46] *Example: Olagade hogalu anumatisu*

		(Allow to go inside).
Send	Kalsi / Kalisthini	Imperative/Verb. Respectful command to send someone or something.[1] *Example: Location kalsi (Send the location).*
Open / Remove	Tegeyiri / Tege	Imperative/Verb. Used for opening doors or removing items.[1] *Example: Bagilu tegeyiri (Open the door).*
Drop / Leave	Bidi	Imperative/Verb. Used to instruct drivers or to let something go.[1] *Example: Illi bidi (Drop me here).* [12]
Village	Halli	Noun. Demonstrates the p -> h shift from *Palli*.[1] *Example: Namma halli (Our village).*
City	Nagara	Noun. Formal term for urban areas.[45] *Example: Bengaluru dodda nagara (Bengaluru is a big city).*
Rain	Male	Noun. Essential weather vocabulary.[45] *Example: Male bartide (It is raining).* [45]
Flower	Hoovu	Noun. Demonstrates the p -> h shift from *Poo*.[1] *Example: Hoovu chennagide (The flower is nice).*
Trouble / Nuisance	Kirik	Slang noun. Describes an irritating argument, a chaotic situation, or a

		problematic individual.[1] *Example: Avanu kirik maadtane (He causes trouble).*
Useless / Bad Quality	Dabba	Slang noun/adjective. Literally translates to "tin box". Used metaphorically to describe bad quality.[1] *Example: Idu dabba (This is useless).*
Fantastic / Excellent	Bombaat / Sakkath	Slang adjectives. Used enthusiastically to describe exceptionally good food, weather, or experiences.[1] *Example: Oota bombaat agittu (Food was fantastic).*
Shredded / Amazing	Chindi	Slang adjective. Literally means "torn/shredded". Used colloquially to mean something was executed perfectly.[1] *Example: Bike chindi agide (The bike is amazing).* [7]
Brother / Dude	Maga / Macha	Slang noun. *Maga* literally means "son", while *Macha* implies brother-in-law. Universal markers of camaraderie.[1] *Example: Yen macha? (What's up, bro?)* [7]
Boss / Teacher	Guru	Slang noun. Universally used to address auto drivers, tea stall vendors, or male strangers respectfully but casually.[1] *Example: Yen guru, yen samachar? (Hey boss, what's up?)* [10]

Pubic Hair (Vulgar / Get lost)	Shaata	Vulgar slang. While literally meaning pubic hair, it is used aggressively to tell someone to get lost.[7] *Example: Shaata! (Get lost!)* [7]
Lie	Sullu	Noun. Often combined with slang (e.g., *Duvv*) to call out falsehoods.[7] *Example: Sullu helbeda (Don't tell lies).* [7]
Compromise / Make space	Swalpa adjust maadi	Idiomatic phrase. A cultural cornerstone of Bengaluru. Used to request physical space or a negotiation.[1] *Example: Bus nalli swalpa adjust maadi (Please adjust a little in the bus).*
Shared Coffee	By-two	Colloquial culinary term. The practice of ordering one filter coffee and splitting it into two glasses.[42] *Example: Ondu by-two coffee kodi (Give one shared coffee).* [7]
See you later	Hogi bartini	Idiomatic farewell. Literally translates to "Having gone, I will come." Culturally, stating "I am going" is inauspicious.[1] *Example: Naanu hogi bartini (I'll take leave/see you later).* [10]
Food done?	Oota aytha?	Idiomatic greeting. Asked after saying hello. Serving as a primary social icebreaker.[1] *Example: Oota aytha guru? (Had food,*

		boss?) [10]
Hey bro, what's up?	Yen guru, yen samachar?	Colloquial greeting. Highly casual, used among peers or to establish immediate, friendly rapport.[9] *Example: Yen guru, yen samachar? (Hey bro, what's up?)* [9]
Reduce it a little	Swalpa kami maadi	Conversational phrase. The standard, polite mechanism for initiating bargaining in a market.[1] *Example: Bele swalpa kami maadi (Reduce the price a bit).* [3]
I'm getting late	Naanu late aagideeni	Conversational phrase. Employs Kanglish. Useful for urging auto drivers to speed up.[3] *Example: Naanu late aagideeni, bega hogi (I'm getting late, go fast).* [3]
Do you have time?	Time ideya?	Conversational phrase. Uses Kanglish. Polite way to interrupt a colleague at the office.[3] *Example: Nimage time ideya? (Do you have time?)* [3]

Conclusion

The structured acquisition of this curated lexicon provides far more than mere translational equivalents; it offers a direct interface with the sociolinguistic rhythm of Bengaluru. By internalizing the agglutinative mechanisms of the suffixes, the cultural weight of the *Mahat/Amahat* honorifics, and the specific syntax of the Experiencer Dative, a migrant effectively transcends the barrier of being perceived as a transient outsider.[1] Implementing native Dravidian terminology for domestic administration, combined with the strategic deployment of localized slang such as *Macha* and *Bombaat*, signals a profound respect for the regional identity of Karnataka. This corpus, when integrated into daily repetition, serves as the cognitive bridge required to transition from basic survival logistics to genuine socio-cultural fluency.

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